the antiIndia feeling began to grow and spread rapidly, it became dangerous and risky to be identified as a pro-Indian element, then they did not feel any stake in trying to assert that they were pro-India. Why should they do so, if India was not interested in them? The disastrous result is that now, when Bangladesh is passing through a stage of utter con-

fusion and intense conflict, with different foreign powers trying to take the fullest advantage of the situation, India is at the disadvantage of not having any genuine friends who have the necessary power to influence events there in any effective manner. It is true that primarily for their own interest some of the Bangladeshis might approach India but that should not be taken as a measure of the goodwill which prevails in Bangladesh towards India. Now, there is hardly any visible and effective influence of India in Bangladesh. This is absolutely disastrous for preservation of India's vital interests in the region.

Plot to Regain the Lost Country

There was intense debate in diplomatic circles and in the intelligence community about how to regain the lost ground in Bangladesh. India's relations with Bangladesh had to be thoroughly reappraised and the government had to formulate a long-term foreign relations strategy for Bangladesh with effective and efficient machinery to implement it. The top officials who analysed the psychological factors in Bangladesh before drafting a blueprint for future relations noted that Bangladeshis had been subjected to intense anti-India and antiHindu propaganda for nearly two decades before liberation when the country had been a part of Pakistan. The officials argued that this must have left some residue in the